

Partner vs Reseller Relationship



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1. Purpose

TD SYNEX must have a reseller relationship with any end user tenant that will be purchasing CSP licenses or subscriptions.

Microsoft requires TD SYNEX, and an indirect reseller have a partner relationship in order for the indirect reseller to qualify for incentives.

A single tenant may have either a reseller relationship or a partner relationship with a TD SYNEX Partner Center (PAC).

Some resellers have a reseller relationship with the same PAC that houses their end user customers. This prevents the reseller from establishing a partner relationship.

This document is intended to provide guidance on how to overcome the reseller vs partner relationship issue.

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3. Reference

3.1. Program Definitions

Microsoft Cloud Solution Provider (CSP) Program

The Microsoft Cloud Solution Provider (CSP) program is designed to help partners build and grow their cloud businesses by enabling them to sell Microsoft cloud services along with their own solutions and services. The program allows partners to manage the entire customer lifecycle, including billing, support, and customer management, providing a comprehensive and flexible approach to delivering cloud solutions.

Partner Center

Also referred to as Partner Administration Center (PAC).

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Partner Center is a platform provided by Microsoft that enables partners to manage their relationship with Microsoft and their customers. It serves as a unified console where partners can access a wide range of partner-centric activities, including managing their Microsoft account and users, engaging with customers, building relationships with other partners, enrolling in incentive programs, managing customer subscriptions, billing, and getting paid.

There are four parties involved in the CSP program:

Microsoft

Microsoft owns the resources provided through the program. They are ultimately responsible for the resources, their availability, and supporting the resources. Microsoft will always have administrative access to the end user tenant.

Indirect/Direct Provider

The indirect/direct provider has a direct billing relationship with Microsoft. The provider receives an invoice from Microsoft.

An indirect provider sells to end user customers through indirect resellers. Direct providers can sell directly to end user customers.

The provider is the only party that can directly interact with Microsoft regarding billing and support.

End user customers are often unaware of the indirect provider and their role.

TD SYNEX is an indirect provider.

Indirect Reseller

The indirect reseller purchases from an indirect provider and resells the services to the end user. The indirect reseller is responsible for the relationship with end user and is responsible for invoicing the end user for the services purchased.

There is no indirect reseller when there is a Direct Provider since the direct provider sells directly to end users.

End User

The consumer of the Microsoft services.

The end user owns the Azure Active Directory tenant and has the sole right to determine who may have permissions to access the tenant and which permissions they may have.

The end user may remove permissions at any time using the tools provided by Microsoft.

There are two types of Partner Center relationships. A specific tenant may only have one type of relationship with a Partner Center at a time:

Reseller Relationship

A reseller relationship is the establishment of a formal relationship between a CSP partner and a customer. This relationship allows the partner to manage and sell Microsoft cloud subscriptions and services to the customer. The process begins when a CSP partner, such

as an indirect reseller, wants to establish a reseller relationship with a customer. The partner must send an invitation to the customer, which includes a reseller relationship link.

The customer receives this link and must accept the invitation to formalize the relationship. This acceptance grants the CSP partner the ability to manage the customer's subscriptions and services through the Partner Center. The reseller relationship does not provide access to the customer's environment but allows the partner to handle administrative tasks such as billing and support.

An example of a multi-party reseller relationship link:

<https://admin.microsoft.com/Adminportal/Home?invType=IndirectResellerRelationship&partnerId=aAAAAAAA-BBBb-cCCCC-0000-098765432123&msppId=1234567&indirectCSPId=12345678-BBBb-cCCCC-0000-123456789012#/partners/invitation>

Partner Relationship

A partner relationship is a mechanism that facilitates the establishment of a formal relationship between a CSP provider and an indirect reseller.

When a CSP provider wants to establish a relationship with an indirect reseller, they initiate the process by sending an invitation that includes a unique partner relationship link. This link is generated through the Partner Center.

An example of a partner relationship link:

<https://partnercenter.microsoft.com/dashboard/v2/customers/indirectresellers/relationshiprequest/12345678-BBBb-cCCCC-0000-123456789012>

3.2. Comparing Reseller and Partner Relationship Links

Both reseller relationship links and partner relationship links are essential for establishing formal connections between different entities, but they serve distinct purposes and involve different processes.

A **reseller relationship link** is used to establish a formal relationship between CSP partners, such as indirect providers/indirect resellers, and an end user customer. This link allows the CSP partner to manage and sell Microsoft cloud subscriptions and services to the customer.

On the other hand, a **partner relationship link** is used to establish a connection between an indirect reseller and an indirect provider. This link provides authorization for the indirect provider partnership, allowing the indirect provider to submit orders and add subscriptions on behalf of the reseller's customers.

In summary, while both types of links are used to establish formal relationships within the CSP program, a reseller relationship link connects a CSP partner with a customer; however, a partner relationship link connects an indirect reseller with an indirect provider.

3.3. Removing a Reseller Relationship

A reseller relationship may only be removed by the provider and only if there are no licenses or subscriptions related to the tenant.

Before a reseller relationship can be removed, the provider must:

- Suspend legacy subscriptions
- Cancel NCE subscriptions

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- Cancel any Azure reserved instance or Azure Savings Plan
- Cancel any software purchases
- Cancel Marketplace SaaS subscriptions

Alternatively, a reseller relationship can be established with another TD SYNEX PAC and the licenses may be transferred to the second PAC. Then the reseller relationship can be cancelled in the first PAC.

Transferring to another PAC does not work for software purchases, they must be canceled then repurchased in the new PAC. Microsoft does not give refunds for cancelled software purchases.

4. Scenarios

4.1. Reseller Sells to End User Tenants and Purchases for Their Tenant

TD SYNEX recommends that indirect resellers establish a dedicated tenant used only for managing their end users (a Partner Center tenant). They would continue to use their corporate tenant as their “daily driver” housing their email, collaboration tools, and applications.

In the past, many resellers used their corporate tenant for both daily work and as their Partner Center tenant. Since they needed licenses for their corporate work, they would not establish a partner relationship with TD SYNEX and would only establish a reseller relationship. Since they now must establish a partner relationship to continue to be in the program, they have a “Catch 22” situation.

The best practice solution would be to re-establish their CSP agreement in a new tenant and move their customers to the new tenant. For some resellers this is not practical.

To resolve the issue, while leaving the reseller’s customers in the old PAC:

1. TD SYNEX account manager determines which PAC to which they will move the reseller corporate tenant.
2. TD SYNEX account manager gets billing records established in the platform supporting the new PAC.
3. Establish a reseller relationship between the corporate tenant and another TD SYNEX PAC.
4. Perform a CSP-to-CSP transfer to move the corporate tenant licenses/subscriptions to the new PAC.
5. Repurchase any software licenses required in the new PAC.
6. Open a support case with Microsoft to cancel any software purchases. No refunds will be provided by Microsoft.
7. TD SYNEX will then break the reseller relationship in the old PAC.
8. Reseller accepts the partner relationship in the old PAC.
9. Reseller generates a new multi-channel reseller relationship from their Partner Center which they will provide to their customers. The reseller should reestablish the reseller relationship with existing customers using the new link.
10. TD SYNEX updates records in old and new PACs to ensure correct billing.

4.2. Reseller Sells to End Users from Their Tenant

TD SYNEX recommends that indirect resellers establish a dedicated tenant used only for managing their end users (a Partner Center tenant). They would continue to use their corporate tenant as their “daily driver” housing their email, collaboration tools, and applications.

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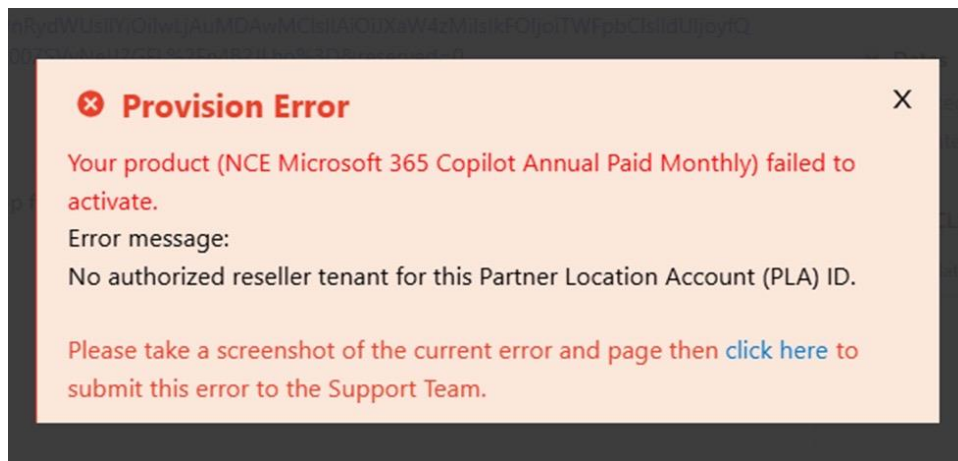
Some resellers will provision subscriptions in the reseller's corporate tenant then charge the end user customer for the consumption. This method poses a lot of challenges and risks and is not best practices.

Since the CSP tenant cannot be separated from the end users, a new tenant will be required. The reseller will create a new tenant to be used for management. The new tenant will need to register to be a CSP reseller then the existing tenant will become a customer of the new tenant.

1. The reseller will create a new management tenant which will become a CSP reseller.
2. The new tenant will establish a partner relationship with the TD SYNnex PAC where the existing tenant is housed.
3. The existing tenant may be transferred to the PAC or remain in the PAC if already there.
4. TD SYNnex account manager gets billing records established in the platform with the new tenant as the reseller of record.
5. If the existing tenant is already in a PAC, TD SYNnex will change the MPN on the subscriptions to the MPN of the new tenant.
6. TD SYNnex updates records in old and new PACs to ensure correct billing.

5. Errors

As of the date of this document, TD SYNnex does not have examples of the errors that will be shown should a reseller not have a partner relationship; however, when an order is placed, we expect an error to be returned from Microsoft similar to the following:



This document will be updated as more information becomes available.

6. Definitions

Term	Definition
End User	The organization that actually uses or consumes the Azure resources to satisfy a business requirement. Usually the customer of the reseller.
GUID	A globally unique identifier (GUID) is a 16 byte, or a 128 bit integer that can be used across all computers and networks wherever a unique identifier is required. Such a number has a very low probability of being

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	duplicated. It is formatted like "12345678-BBBb-cCCCC-0000-123456789012"
Microsoft ID	The globally unique identifier (GUID) of a Microsoft customer. Also referred to as a Tenant ID or Directory ID. For a provider, the Microsoft ID required is the ID of the tenant used to manage the end user subscriptions. A provider may have multiple Microsoft ID's; however, only the one will work for this purpose.
Microsoft Partner Number (MPN)	A unique identifier of a Microsoft partner in the Microsoft Partner Network (MPN). A company may have multiple MPN's but the one associated with CSP is the one required. The correct name is Microsoft Partner ID or MPN ID.
Partner Center	The Microsoft Azure Partner Center is a platform that streamlines business processes for partners, enabling them to manage their accounts, engage with customers, co-sell with Microsoft, and access a range of tools and resources for business growth.
Partner Relationship	A partner relationship is a connection between an indirect reseller and an indirect provider. It provides authorization of an indirect provider partnership and allows their full access to submit orders and add subscriptions on behalf of your customers.
Provider	The company that purchases Azure subscriptions from and receives an invoice directly from Microsoft. The Provider may be either Direct (acting as a provider and reseller) or Indirect (acting as on a provider). TD SYNnex is an Indirect provider.
Reseller	The company that purchases Azure subscriptions from TD Synnex and sells the subscription to the end user.
Reseller Relationship	A reseller relationship allows the provider to sell Microsoft cloud subscriptions and services to end user customers. It does not provide access to the end user's environment.

7. Associated Documents

- [Cloud Solution Provider program overview - Partner Center | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [What is Partner Center? - Partner Center | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Supported CSP partner relationships - Partner Center | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Work with indirect providers in the CSP program - Partner Center | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Request a reseller relationship with a customer - Partner Center | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Remove reseller relationship with a customer - Partner Center | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Cloud Solution Provider Security Best Practices - Partner Center | Microsoft Learn](#)

8. Document Approval

This document has been approved by:

- Manager, Cloud Sales Engineering

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9. Document Revision History

<i>Number</i>	<i>Effective Date</i>	<i>Revision History</i>	<i>Author</i>
1.0	5/13/2025	Initial Draft	David Bloom
1.1	5/13/2025	Added second scenario	David Bloom

10. Appendix A – TD SYNEX Reseller Relationship Links

The following links establish a link between TD SYNEX and the end user. We do not recommend using “single party” links as they do not satisfy Microsoft’s CSP program requirements for Indirect providers/indirect resellers.

Indirect resellers should generate multi-channel links from their Partner Center.

PAC	Link
Stellr US	https://admin.microsoft.com/Adminportal/Home?invType=ResellerRelationship&partnerId=ff1b2576-d461-4916-97dc-7ada1cd798dc&msspId=0#/partners/invitation
ION US (SIE)	https://admin.microsoft.com/Adminportal/Home?invType=ResellerRelationship&partnerId=d3e363db-81d0-4c04-9bb4-bced62c60825&msspId=0#/partners/invitation
SCM US	https://admin.microsoft.com/Adminportal/Home?invType=ResellerRelationship&partnerId=d5c77776-8b4c-4ceb-81da-566aba9c59c5&msspId=0#/partners/invitation
Stellr CA	https://admin.microsoft.com/Adminportal/Home?invType=ResellerRelationship&partnerId=47381036-1bd3-42d6-9a38-4a1651c1556b&msspId=0#/partners/invitation
TD CA	https://admin.microsoft.com/Adminportal/Home?invType=ResellerRelationship&partnerId=10ad3e17-3bca-4f0a-973b-549bec7013f4&msspId=0#/partners/invitation
AVT CA	https://admin.microsoft.com/Adminportal/Home?invType=ResellerRelationship&partnerId=b5eaa3e9-9b5f-491c-aa1a-d72754746981&msspId=0#/partners/invitation
Stellr US Govt	https://portal.office365.us/Adminportal/Home?invType=ResellerRelationship&partnerId=818dbb9f-45ed-4ad9-85fa-b83e60d44522&msspId=0&DAP=true#/partners/invitation
TechData US Govt	https://portal.office365.us/Adminportal/Home?invType=ResellerRelationship&partnerId=14b41297-2bc3-4107-a160-6414fb289339&msspId=0&DAP=true#/partners/invitation

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11. Appendix B – Partner Relationship Links

The reseller only needs to establish a partner relationship with the PAC in which their customers will transact. The reseller should contact their TD SYNEX account manager for the correct one to choose.

Note: These links are for PACs not eCommerce platforms. Multiple PACs exist in each eCommerce platform.

PAC	Domain	Link
Stellr US	synnex365.com	https://partnercenter.microsoft.com/commerce/indirectresellers/relationshiprequest/ff1b2576-d461-4916-97dc-7ada1cd798dc
SCM US	tdmsft.com	https://partnercenter.microsoft.com/commerce/indirectresellers/relationshiprequest/d5c77776-8b4c-4ceb-81da-566aba9c59c5
SIE (ION) US	TechDataTSAVT.onmicrosoft.com	https://partnercenter.microsoft.com/commerce/indirectresellers/relationshiprequest/d3e363db-81d0-4c04-9bb4-bced62c60825
Stellr CA	synnexca.onmicrosoft.com	https://partnercenter.microsoft.com/commerce/indirectresellers/relationshiprequest/47381036-1bd3-42d6-9a38-4a1651c1556b
TD CA	techdatacanada.com	https://partnercenter.microsoft.com/commerce/indirectresellers/relationshiprequest/10ad3e17-3bca-4f0a-973b-549bec7013f4
AVT CA	TechDataS1ECA.onmicrosoft.com	https://partnercenter.microsoft.com/commerce/indirectresellers/relationshiprequest/b5eaa3e9-9b5f-491c-aa1a-d72754746981
Stellr US Gov	synnexagc.onmicrosoft.com	https://partnercenter.microsoft.com/commerce/indirectresellers/relationshiprequest/818dbb9f-45ed-4ad9-85fa-b83e60d44522
AVT US Gov	TDAzureGov.onmicrosoft.com	https://partnercenter.microsoft.com/commerce/indirectresellers/relationshiprequest/14b41297-2bc3-4107-a160-6414fb289339